

Go deep, not wide.

Eight apps, paying for half of them, good at none of them. The win is not finding a new tool. It is going deep on the one already in your hand.

THE SHIFT

Most flashy AI tools are not new AI. They are a wrapper, a nice looking package built on top of the same handful of big models underneath. **Same engine, new paint job, and a monthly charge.**

Ask one question first

Before you pay for anything, ask what it does that your main tool cannot already do.

If the answer is nothing really, it just looks easier, save your money.

Look under the hood

Check the terms of service, the developer docs, or the about page.

Plenty of them say outright whose model they are running on.

Fluency compounds

Every hour in one tool makes the next task faster in that same tool. You learn where it is strong and where it gets lazy.

Tool hopping resets you to zero every time.

WHAT THIS MEANS AT WORK

Your tools are already chosen

You do not need to go shopping. There are years of capability in the two or three tools on your organization's list that almost nobody ever touches.

Some tools do earn it

A few genuinely do one thing better than a general assistant. That is fair. Just know exactly why you need it before you pay for it.

Think of your tool belt

If you have a good set of tools and you know how to use them, you do not buy a specialty gadget for every task. Most of those gadgets do what your good tools already do. You just had not learned the full range of what you had.

YOUR CHALLENGE THIS WEEK

Pick one tool. Just one. Instead of trying something new, find one feature you did not know was there.

Then push it on something messy and real, not the easy stuff. That is where fluency actually gets built.

Before you send anything, read it. You are the pilot. AI is the co-pilot. Every decision still goes through you.

Next episode · **Build your workspace.** Stop starting from zero every time you open it.

YOUR ORGANIZATION NAME
AND LOGO